## Minority Party

Those with lesser number of elected candidates are called the minority party.

## Opposition Party

The party which gets the second largest number of seats next to the majority party in the election is called the Opposition party. An effective opposition is very essential for the successful operation of the democracy. They are as important as that of the ruling party. They check the autocratic tendencies of the ruling party. They critically examine the policies and bills introduced by the government. They raise their voice on the failures and wrong policies. They highlight important issues which are not acted upon the Government. The leader of the opposition party enjoys the rank of Cabinet Minister.

## Coalition Government

In a Multiparty system a single party sometimes may not secure the majority required to form the government. In such a case, some parties join together to form the government. Such government is called Coalition Government.

## Electoral Symbols and its importance

An electoral symbol is a standardised symbol allocated to a political party. They play an important role in elections. They can be easily identified, understood, remembered and recognized by the voters. The Election commission has stopped allotting animals as symbols. The only exceptions are the lion and the elephant. The symbol of nationally recognized parties is standard throughout India. That symbol will not be allotted to any other party or individual.

State parties are allotted to certain symbols that no other party can use the symbol in that particular state but which different parties in different states can use the same symbol. (e.g Shiv Sena in Maharashtra and Jharkhand Mukti Morsha in Jharkhand use bow and arrow as their symbol).

Both National and Regional parties trigger the growth of the nation and work for the welfare of the people.

| National Party | Regional /State Party |
|---|---|
| National parties are political parties which participate in different elections all over India. | Regional parties are political parties which participate in different elections but only within one state. |
| It should be strong enough in at least four states. | It should be strong enough in at least one or two states. |
| It has an exclusive symbol throughout the country. | A symbol is reserved for it in the state in which it is recognized. But the same symbol can be allotted to different parties in different states. |
| It resolves State, National and International issues. | It promotes State and regional interest. |



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